

Each woven nest is over 3 ft 3 in (1 m) long and hangs from a tree branch.

Crested oropendola

Crested oropendolas live in groups and nest together, too. They can build up to 100 nests in just one tree. This probably helps protect the eggs and young from predators, as the birds can warn each other of danger. The male has a spectacular courtship display to attract a female. He makes a series of loud gurgling sounds while flapping his wings and leaning forward so far that he almost falls off his perch.

Crested oropendola
(*Psarocolius decumanus*)
Length: 1 ft 7 in (48 cm)

Mouth opens very wide to allow the bird to swallow large fruits.

Wattles hang from top of bill and edge of mouth.

Three-wattled bellbird
(*Procnias tricarunculatus*)
Length: 1 ft (30 cm)

Three-wattled bellbird

Male bellbirds make one of the loudest calls of any bird. They advertise for a female by producing an explosive “bock” noise. This call can be heard 0.6 miles (1 km) away. The female builds the nest and looks after the young. She is a dull color to camouflage her while she sits on the nest.

Constantly jerks head while perched.

Long, straight bill for snapping up insects.

Puerto Rican tody

This tody lives in woods and forests and feeds by pouncing on insects from a perch. When it flies, it makes a whirring noise with its wings. During the breeding season, the tody uses its bill to dig tiny nesting burrows in a bank, like its relative the kingfisher. There are four other species of Caribbean tody.

Puerto Rican tody
(*Todus mexicanus*)
Length: 5 in (12 cm)

Sunbittern

During its courtship display, the sunbittern spreads its wings to show off the patches of orange and yellow on its feathers. These look like the colors of a sky at sunset, which is how the bird got its name. At other times, the mottled colors on the feathers camouflage the bird as it searches for food along stream banks in woodland areas. It catches fish, insects, and frogs with its long, sharp bill.

Sunbittern
(*Eurypyga helias*)
Length: 1 ft 7 in (48 cm)

Wings are spread out during courtship displays.

Black skimmer
(*Rynchops niger*)
Length: 1 ft 6 in (46 cm)

Black skimmer

The black skimmer has a strange bill—the bottom part is about one-third longer than the top part. To find food, the skimmer flies over shallow water with its bill open. When its bill hits a small fish or crustacean, the skimmer snaps the top bill down to trap its prey.



Dense jungle vegetation is typical of Central America's tropical rainforests.

Amazon
Tapajós